



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, March 16, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 6:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 6 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Philip Lindholm and Ryan Pearson.

Councilmember Excused: 1 – Councilmember J. Trestin Lauricella.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi paused for a moment of silence and led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Business Showcase – Lakewood Auto Body

MAYOR BOCCHI RECOGNIZED ANDY AND ELIZABETH MUELLER, LAKEWOOD AUTO BODY AS THE MARCH 2026 BUSINESS SHOWCASE.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

The City Council received written comments in advance of the meeting from Tricia Parsons.

Tichomir Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about sidewalk projects and impacts to trees.

Linda Smith, Lakewood Chamber of Commerce, expressed opposition to the city implementing a Business and Occupancy tax.

Kris Kauffman, Lakewood resident, spoke about the cityhood transition team and recognized former leaders Bill Larkin, Ed Starbird and Sylvia Kauffman.

Haley Ivey, Lakewood resident, spoke about the tree canopy at Edgewater and Seeley Lake Parks, Chambers Creek Watershed pollution and invasive species.

Helen Wagner, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of the preservation of the tree canopy.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke in support of first amendment rights, the ability for residents to make public comments and life of former public commenter Haugen.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke about the ecosystem being a living connection to history and in support of expanding education on the City's native habitat.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke in support of redesign of the Custer Road Sidewalk Improvement Project to allow for the preservation of the Garry Oak trees and ecosystem in the area.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, requested a moment of silence for those who were attacked at a school in Minab, Iran and spoke in support of a seize fire.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of March 2, 2026.

B. Motion No. 2026-21

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with SCJ Alliance, in the amount of \$100,000, for the Camp Murray Boat Launch Master Plan.

C. Motion No. 2026-22

Updating the 2026 Planning Commission Work Plan.

D. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

1. Arts Commission meeting minutes of February 9, 2026.
2. Planning Commission meeting minutes of February 18, 2026.

Councilmember Brandstetter requested that Motion No. 2026-21 be removed from the Consent Agenda.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA, MINUS ITEM B, MOTION NO. 2026-21. SECONDED BY DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE MOVED TO ADOPT MOTION NO. 2026-21. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO DELAY CONSIDERATION OF MOTION NO. 2026-21 UNTIL THE APRIL 6, 2026 CITY COUNCIL MEETING. THERE BEING NO SECOND, THE MOTION TO FAILS.

VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN ON MOTION NO. 2026-21 AND CARRIED WITH COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 847 Granting Ziplly Fiber Pacific, LLC DBA Ziplly Fiber, a non-exclusive franchise for the transmission of telecommunications in, through, over and under the rights-of-way of the City of Lakewood.

DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 847. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

Ordinance No. 848 Granting NFC Northwest, LLC, a non-exclusive franchise agreement for the transmission of telecommunications in, through, over and under the rights-of-way of the City of Lakewood.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 848. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

ITEMS FOR DISCUSSION**Update and Request for Direction regarding H-Barn Restoration Project.**

Roxanne Miles, Parks, Recreation & Community Services Director shared that as a result of increased cost estimates for the H-Barn restoration project, prior to proceeding to 60% design, options are being considered to maximize efficiency, function and keep the essence of the H-Barn and silos for the community and future users. Discussion ensued whether to design around a prefabricated building, toward renovation of the barns using salvageable elements of the structures or using the barn as a passive space. After discussion a meeting between Partners for Parks, Councilmembers Brandstetter, Pearson and Talbo and the Parks and Recreation Advisory Board will be held to discuss the concept and business plan prior to proceeding.

Review of the FY 2026 Annual Action Plan for Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) and HOME Programs.

Jeff Gumm, Program Manager shared that the 2026 Annual Action Plan is a framework for how the city will utilize its CDBG and HOME funds. He reviewed the eligible activities to serve community interests and funding allocations for 2026 for CDBG and HOME programs.

He then reviewed the public participation process for the Annual Action Plan and shared that next steps include a public hearing by the City Council on April 20th, a review by the Planning Commission with final approval by the City Council on May 4th and submission to HUD by May 15th.

At 8:25 p.m., Mayor Bocchi announced that the City Council will recess for 10 minutes. The City Council reconvened at 8:35 p.m.

Review of amendments to Lakewood Municipal Code Chapter 5.60 related to Rental Housing Licensing.

Jeff Gumm, Program Manager provided an overview of the history of the Rental Housing Safety Program (RHSP) and shared that it is recommended that the City Council adopt an Ordinance amending the program licensing and registration requirements. He shared that an

Ordinance will come forward for Council approval on April 6, 2026.
Discussion ensued.

Review of Resolution updating the City's Purchasing Policies.

Heidi Ann Wachter, City Attorney shared that the proposed purchasing policies align with state law and a Resolution will come forward for Council approval on April 20th.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- March 17, 5:30 P.M., Custer Neighborhood Association, Dower Elementary School
- March 28, 6:00 P.M., Informed Citizen Panel on Homelessness, Lakewood Playhouse
- March 28-29, 8:00 A.M. – 2 P.M., Spring Community Clean Up, Lemay Transfer Station
- April 1, 6:00 P.M., Mayors Coffeehouse, Fort Steilacoom Park Pavilion
- April 18, 8:00 A.M., City Council Retreat, City Hall Council Chambers

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Talbo requested an update on trees being removed for the Custer Road Sidewalk Improvement Project.

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that he will attend the Unified Approach to Homelessness meeting on March 20th and he looks forward to the City Council Retreat on April 18th.

Councilmember Lindholm thanked those who provided public comments this evening.

Deputy Mayor Belle reflected on the public comments related to the history of the city and she spoke about the Youth Council meeting this evening where there was a Beloved Community panel discussion.

Mayor Bocchi reflected on the vision of the City and the work that has been completed throughout the city since incorporation. He shared that he will present at Lakewood Rotary on April 3rd.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:22 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK